

Example of emails sent to a professor before applying:

Fwd: Prospective Graduate Student

Dr. Kornbluth,

I am a senior biology major at the [REDACTED]. I am applying to the CMB program and am very interested in your work. After glancing at a few of your recent papers and your research summary I find your work with apoptosis very interesting. Will you be taking on new students next year? If I am invited to interview, is there any way you will be able to meet with me?

I have worked on several different research projects as an undergraduate in [REDACTED] at the [REDACTED]. The [REDACTED] is interested in the signals that initiate Muller glia division post-light damage. My first research project was characterizing the role of leukemia inhibitory factor (LIF) in the activation of cell proliferation in the undamaged zebrafish retina. I am also working on several experiments that are related to a genetic screen that the [REDACTED] plans on performing to identify mutants in the regeneration pathway--I am developing a *neuroD4:EGFP* transgenic line for use in this screen and I am characterizing the extent of damage and regeneration in *sheer* zebrafish retinas. Finally, I am characterizing the *chx10:EGFP* transgenic line during retinal development and regeneration.

Please find my CV attached.

Thank you for your time,

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED],

I am a senior biology major at the [REDACTED]. I am applying to your graduate program and am very interested in your work. After glancing at a few of your recent papers and your research summary I find your research greatly coincides with my research experiences and interests. Will you be taking on new students next year?

I have worked on several different research projects as an undergraduate in [REDACTED] at the [REDACTED]. The [REDACTED] is interested in the signals that initiate Muller glia division post-light damage. My first research project was characterizing the role of leukemia inhibitory factor (LIF) in the activation of cell proliferation in the undamaged zebrafish retina. I am also working on several experiments that are related to a genetic screen that the [REDACTED] plans on performing to identify mutants in the regeneration pathway--I am developing a *neuroD4:EGFP* transgenic line for use in this screen and I am characterizing the extent of damage and

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